STYLISH NAARI

WEBSITE BRAND GUIDELINES · VERSION 1.0

Quiet UI. *Expressive* textiles.

Visual direction and design system for the Stylish Naari Shopify storefront. The source of truth for every homepage, template and implementation decision.

September 2026



THE ONE PRINCIPLE

The sarees bring the colour. The interface brings the structure.

If a design choice isn't covered in this document, resolve it with that principle. When two rules seem to conflict, use this order:

1. The campaign photography
2. The real colours, patterns and craft of the sarees
3. Contemporary Indian fashion sensibility
4. Minimal editorial ecommerce principles
5. Restraint, as practised by contemporary Indian lifestyle brands (a benchmark, never a model to copy)

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Rose zari border and gold buti on wine silk. Detail from the campaign.

01

Banarasi, in the *present* tense.

Stylish Naari makes Banarasi sarees for women who wear them now: to a dinner, a friend's sangeet, an opening, a Tuesday that deserves it. The weaving is centuries old. How it is worn and presented is current.



Woven

Real Banarasi craft: silk, zari, motifs made on a loom. The craft gives the brand its authority.



Coloured

Jewel tones and bold contrast borders. Colour is the brand's signature, and it comes from the cloth.



Current

Styled, shot and presented as fashion, not as heritage costume.

What the brand is not: a bridal house, a heritage museum, a palace fantasy, or a discount marketplace.

02

Positioning

A contemporary Indian saree brand rooted in Banarasi weaving, designed for modern Indian women who want craft that feels like fashion.

WE ARE	RATHER THAN
Contemporary	~~Traditional~~
Premium	~~Luxurious~~
Sophisticated	~~Ornate~~
Expressive	~~Flashy~~
Culturally rooted	~~Nostalgic~~
Fashion-forward	~~Bridal~~
Warm	~~Sterile~~
Confident	~~Loud~~

WHERE THE PREMIUM FEEL COMES FROM

From how things are presented, not from signals of expense.

1 Photography that looks like a campaign

2 Scale: images big enough to see the zari

3 Space: generous margins, unhurried sections

4 Typography: a disciplined grotesk, set well

5 Editing: fewer products, words, elements

> Never built from gold gradients, ornamental frames, royal imagery or luxury copywriting.



03

Audience

Indian women, broadly 26–45, urban or urban-connected, fashion-literate. She follows Indian designers as closely as global ones. She owns her mother's sarees and wants her own, ones that look like *her* choice rather than an inheritance.

WHAT SHE VALUES

- Colour
- Craft she can see and feel
- Good design
- Quality she can trust
- Presentation that doesn't talk down to her

WHEN SHE WEARS A SAREE

- Festive occasions and celebrations
- Weddings, as a guest (not a bride)
- Cultural events and dinners
- Increasingly, everyday dressing

WHAT SHE IS TIRED OF

- Websites that look like wedding invitations
- Copy about "timeless elegance"
- Discount pop-ups
- Grids where every saree looks the same, shot flat on the same beige

THE JOB OF THE WEBSITE

Make Banarasi feel like something she'd wear *this season*, not something she keeps for an occasion.

04

Visual personality

Premium through restraint, photography, typography and space. Never through gold, ornament or luxury clichés.

> If you remove the photography and the site feels empty, the UI is right. If it still feels "Indian" without the photography, the UI is doing too much.

QUALITY	LEVEL	IN PRACTICE
Modern		Grotesk type, clean grid, current patterns
Contemporary		Styling, copy and composition belong to now
Minimal		Fewest possible UI elements
Premium		Through restraint, scale, space and craft
Colourful (imagery only)		The sarees carry colour; the UI does not
Editorial		Composed layouts, varied scale, magazine rhythm
Traditional		In the product and craft story, not the UI
Heritage		One dedicated section, not everywhere
Luxury		A price point, not an aesthetic
Playful		In styling and the odd line of copy only
Ornate		The weave is ornate so the website needn't be
Decorative UI		No motifs, frames, dividers or pattern fills

05

Art direction

The five campaign photographs define the visual world. The website is designed around them.



ELEMENT	WHAT THE PHOTOGRAPHY DOES	WHAT THE WEBSITE TAKES FROM IT
Light	Single hard key light, raking shadows, spotlight pools, window-light diagonals	Drama belongs to the image. The UI stays flat and shadowless.
Backdrop	Warm clay, terracotta-sand and plaster walls; seamless studio floors	UI neutrals are warm, pulled from these walls. Never cold grey or pure white.
Graphic device	A single large red disc behind the model	Copy the principle (one strong element, lots of quiet), never the shape itself.
Props	Few and specific: mid-century chair, plaster steps, painted stool, block-printed rug	Cultural references live in the image. The UI adds none of its own.
Pose	Seated, turned away, hand to cheek; relaxed and introspective	Copy mirrors this: at ease, a little knowing, never performing.
Negative space	30–50% of every frame is empty wall	Give images room. Don't fill the image's own negative space with UI by default.
Colour	The saree is always the most saturated object in the frame	The saree must also be the most saturated object on the page.

Image inventory

Four sarees, five frames. Each has a clear best use.



A

Magenta jaal, marigold border

Back view, head in hands, red disc. 2:3.

Hero. The most editorial frame: sculptural, anonymous, graphic.



B

Same magenta saree

Front view, smiling, red disc. 3:4.

Festive Edit. Warm, celebratory, face-forward.



C

Chartreuse–rose ombré

Elephant stool, spotlight pool. 3:4.

New Arrivals; detail crop for The Bright Edit.



D

Wine, gold buti, rose zari

Plaster steps, window light. 3:4.

New Arrivals; macro for The Art of Banarasi.



E

Indigo, aqua-silver border

Back view, forest mural, lotuses. 3:4.

New Arrivals; detail for The Contrast Edit. Busiest set, so crop tight.



Opens · 01 Hero



Closes · 06 Festive Edit

She turns *around.*

The homepage opens on the magenta saree seen from behind and closes on the same saree from the front. A quiet editorial bookend that uses the limited photography on purpose, not by accident.

Homepage allocation

SECTION	IMAGE	CROP
01 Hero	A	Full, landscape extension on desktop
02 New arrivals	C · D · E	Full-body vertical 3:4
03 Shop by edit	B · E · C	Medium portrait / detail / detail
04 Colour story	A/B · C · D · E	Textile macro
05 Art of Banarasi	D	Textile macro (interim)
06 Festive edit	B	Full vertical + border detail

> **Reuse rule.** An image appears at most twice on the homepage, never in adjacent sections at the same crop scale, never twice as a section's dominant image.

ASSET GAPS TO COMMISSION

1. **Landscape hero (A) at 16:9 and 21:9.** Required for launch; the wall is plain seamless paper, an easy retouch.
2. A textile-detail image per product, for card hover and PDP.
3. Craft imagery: loom, jacquard cards, zari bobbins, lit like the campaign.
4. Flat-lay or draped-form shots for collection pages and PDPs only.
5. One lighter, everyday styling story, for an Everyday Edit.

06

Photography direction

SHOOT PRINCIPLES

Model + saree are the subject. Nothing in frame competes.

One idea per set. One backdrop colour, one prop, one graphic element at most.

Hard, directional light. Shadow pools and diagonals, never flat catalogue light.

Warm architectural backdrops: clay, plaster, terracotta, limewash. An occasional single flat colour shape.

Pose with intent: seated, turned, mid-gesture. Never square-on.

Styling: contemporary blouses, sculptural gold cuffs, one flower element; 1–2 jewellery statements.

Show the drape. One frame per saree shows the full pallu and border.

AVOID

Palace interiors and jharokhas · wedding mandaps · temple architecture · flower walls · stacks of bridal jewellery · hands-on-hips catalogue poses · "pre-wedding" golden hour · stock photography · any set more ornate than the saree.

PHOTOGRAPHY ↔ UI

WHEN THE IMAGE…	…THE UI
Is visually rich	Gets quieter: fewer elements, smaller type
Has intense colour	Sits on neutral ivory, never another colour
Has dramatic lighting	Keeps type light-weight and small
Shows an intricate weave	Adds no pattern, texture or motif
Has strong composition	Gets no overlays, badges or frames



A note on image E. The painted forest mural and oversized lotuses sit at the edge of what the brand allows. It works as a single image, cropped tight to the saree. Don't make it the direction for future shoots.

Crop system

Every image placement uses one of five crops. Never crop randomly.



Full-body vertical

3:4 · head to hem
New Arrivals, Festive, PDP



Medium portrait

4:5 · crown to mid-thigh
Edit (large), PDP secondary



Textile detail

5:4 or 1:1 · border meets body
Edit (small), card hover



Textile macro

3:5 or 1:1
Colour Story, Craft



Wide campaign

16:9 / 21:9 · extended backdrop
Hero, campaign banners

CROP RULES

- Never crop through the face, hands or the hem border.
- Never cut a motif in half at the frame edge. Move the frame until one complete buti or border repeat shows.
- Set a Shopify focal point on every image so responsive crops hold the subject.

FOCAL POINTS, CURRENT SET (X / Y)

A	48% / 55%	B	62% / 50%	C	50% / 55%
D	58% / 55%	E	52% / 50%		

The wide campaign example is a quick edge-extension of image A. The final hero needs a proper outpaint.



Desktop hero, 16:9. The mock-up uses a quick edge-extension of image A made for this document; the final build needs a proper outpaint.

07

Hero direction

Image A. The model's anonymity makes it about the saree and the mood. The red disc gives the page one graphic anchor. Unmistakably Indian (gajra, drape, disc as sun or bindi) without a single cliché.

COMPOSITION

Full-bleed, `100svh`.

Disc sits high, model's head just below it, like a halo. **Never set text over the disc.**

Headline bottom-left in the floor shadow, completing the diagonal disc → model → pallu → headline.

Header floats transparently in ivory.

No carousel dots, scroll prompts or secondary CTAs.

THE LANDSCAPE PROBLEM

Image A is a 2:3 portrait; a 16:9 crop would cut the model at the waist. **Launch requirement:** extend the seamless backdrop to 16:9 (≥ 2880×1620) and 21:9, keeping the model in the centre-left third.

FALLBACK

Portrait image at full height, centred on a field sampled from the backdrop (`--color-studio-clay` to umber), with a 200px feathered edge baked in. Never a hard-edged portrait floating on a flat field.

TYPE ON THE HERO

Headline at H1, not Display: the image is the display element. Ivory text. Scrim `rgba(30,22,16,.35)` → transparent at 35%, never visible as a gradient.

APPROVED FOR LAUNCH

TRADITION, REIMAGINED

Handwoven silk and zari, in colours made for today.

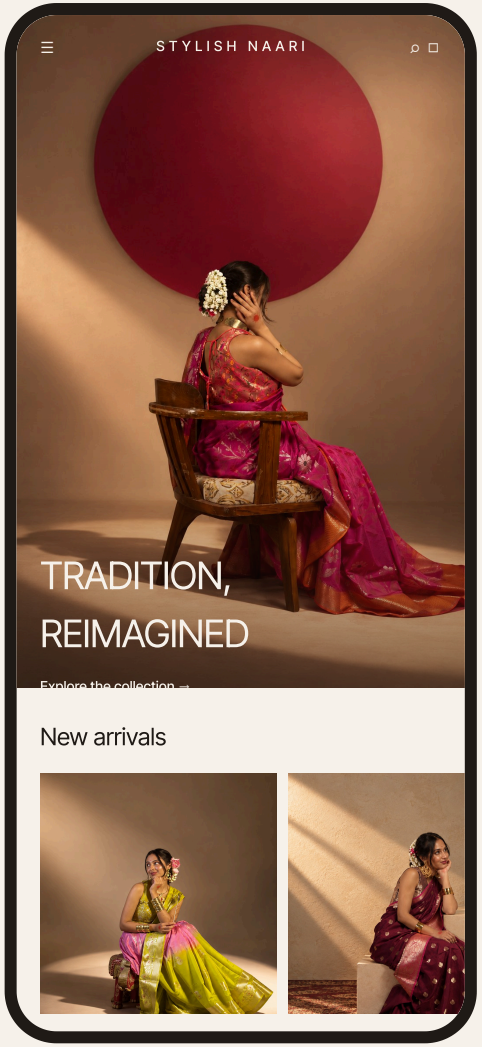
Explore the collection →

ALTERNATES, FOR FUTURE CAMPAIGNS

The new Banarasi.	Handwoven silk and zari, in colours made for now.
Colour, *woven.*	Banarasi silk in magenta, marigold, chartreuse and more.
Woven for now.	The Banarasi, cut loose from the occasion.
Banarasi, in the present tense.	New sarees, handwoven in Varanasi.

RULES

Headline ≤ 5 words, sentence case, ends in a full stop. Supporting line ≤ 10 words.
One CTA, text + arrow, never a filled button over the image.



Mobile: the native 2:3 portrait shows **uncropped** (height = 150vw). The portrait original fits a phone better than a laptop does.

08

Homepage IA

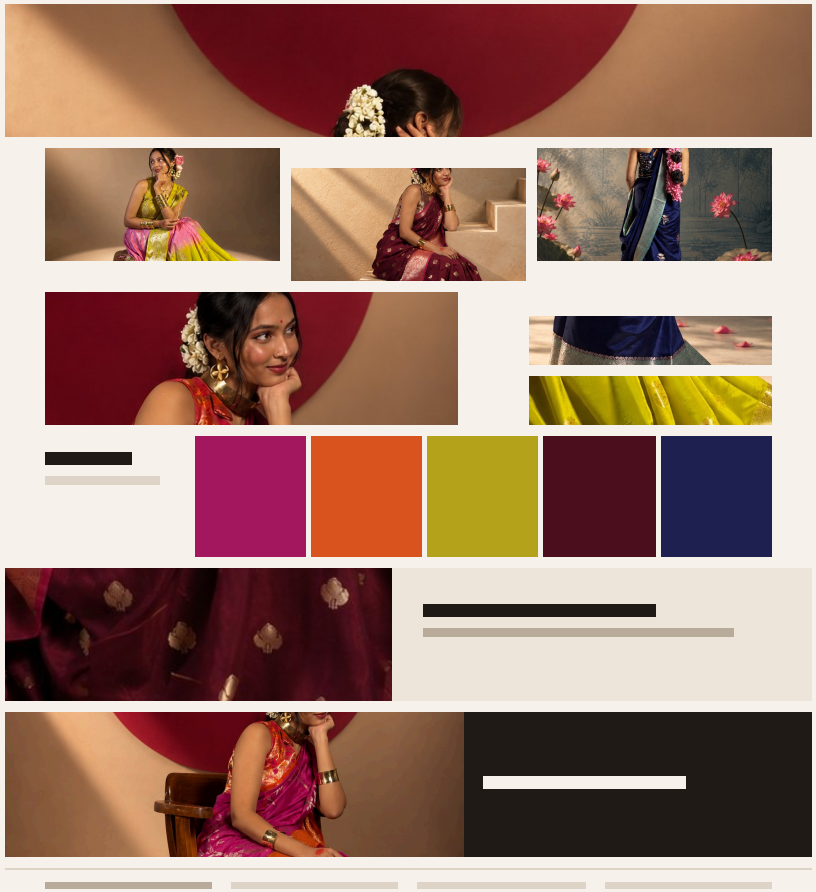
Fixed structure. No additions.

#	SECTION	ROLE	LAYOUT REGISTER	BACKGROUND
01	**Hero**	Establish the brand	Full-bleed image	Image
02	**New arrivals**	Product first	Controlled grid	Ivory
03	**Shop by edit**	Editorial navigation	Asymmetric composition	Ivory
04	**Colour story**	The signature, as editorial	Colour moment	Ivory + fields
05	**The Art of Banarasi**	Craft authority	Image + text, wide space	Stone
06	**Festive edit**	Second campaign moment	Full-height campaign	Ink
07	**Footer**	Navigation, newsletter	Quiet utility	Ivory

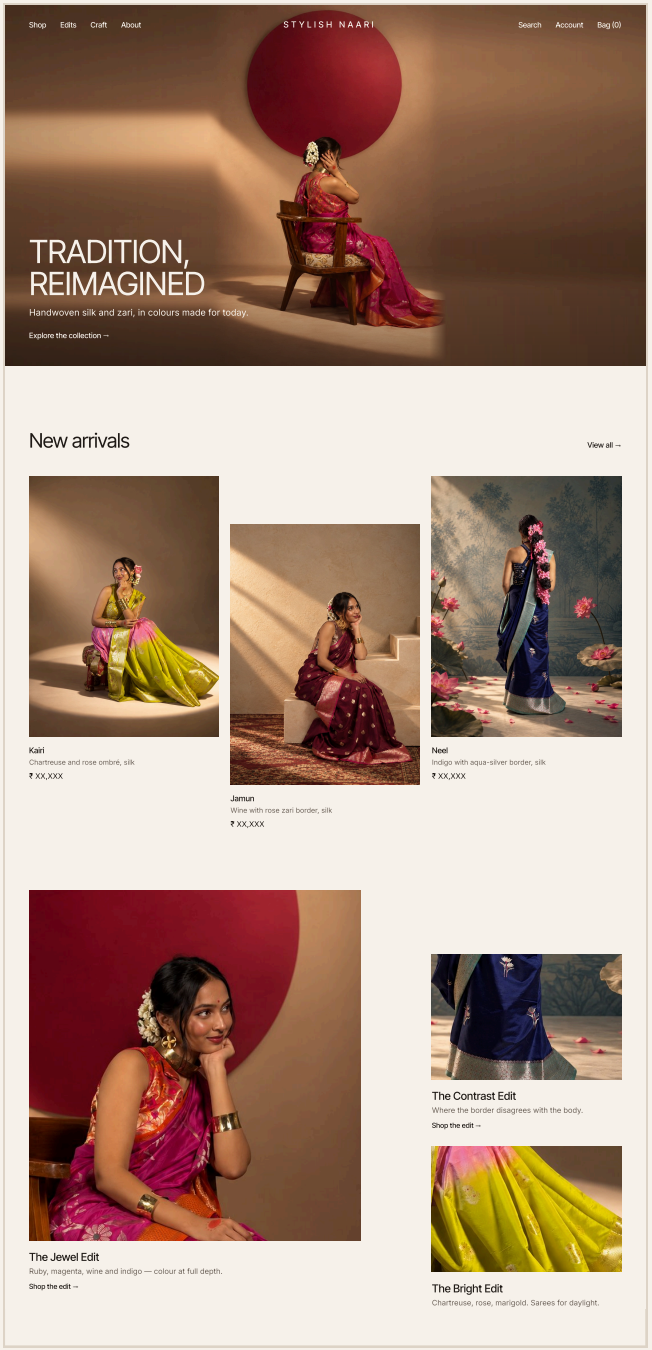
EXCLUDED

Testimonials · Instagram feeds · blog previews · "why choose us" · press logos · trust-badge rows · promotional banners · first-load pop-ups

RHYTHM: NO TWO ADJACENT SECTIONS SHARE A REGISTER



Full-bleed → grid → asymmetry → colour → stillness → full-bleed.



01 HERO

Full-bleed campaign image, restrained transparent header, short headline, one understated CTA.

02 NEW ARRIVALS

Three full-body model images, 4 columns each. **The centre card drops 96px**, a small break that turns a grid into a composition. More than three products → horizontal scroll with the next card peeking in, a 1px progress line, no arrows.

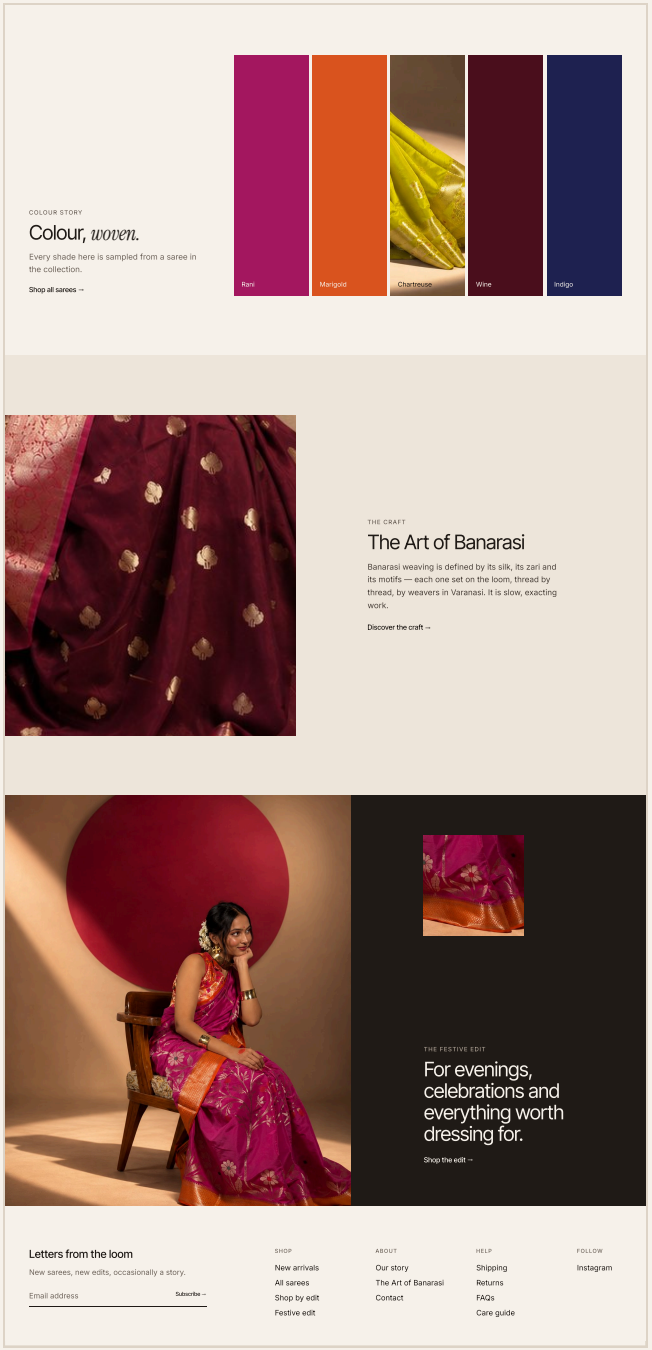
Card info: title · descriptor (muted) · price. No badges, hearts, "NEW", ratings, quick-add, swatches or borders. Only `SOLD OUT` may overlay the image.

03 SHOP BY EDIT

Asymmetric: large medium-portrait card across columns 1–7; **column 8 left empty**; two detail-crop cards stacked in 9–12, starting 128px lower. Text under images, never overlaid. Never three identical tiles.

EDIT	DESCRIPTOR
The Jewel Edit	Ruby, magenta, wine and indigo — colour at full depth.
The Contrast Edit	Where the border disagrees with the body, beautifully.
The Bright Edit	Chartreuse, rose, marigold. Sarees for daylight.

The Everyday Edit joins once lighter everyday styling is shot.



04 COLOUR STORY

Five tall flat colour fields sampled from real sarees, each named. On hover each field crossfades (800ms) to a textile macro of the saree it came from; the mock-up shows Chartreuse mid-hover. The only place jewel tones become UI surfaces. Never a filter widget, swatch dots or gradients.

05 THE ART OF BANARASI

Stone background, the only shift before the footer. A textile macro **bleeds off the left edge**; copy ≤ 60 words in columns 8–11. No timeline, dates, statistics, maps or loom illustrations.

06 FESTIVE EDIT

The only dark section. Image B full height in columns 1–7, a small marigold-border detail and ivory copy in 9–12. No sparkles, diyas or "Diwali sale" styling. Out of season, the same section carries the next campaign.

07 FOOTER

Ivory, separated from Festive by the colour change alone. Newsletter first; four link groups; a small bottom bar. No background image, pattern band, payment-icon row or gold.

SECTION 04 CONCEPT

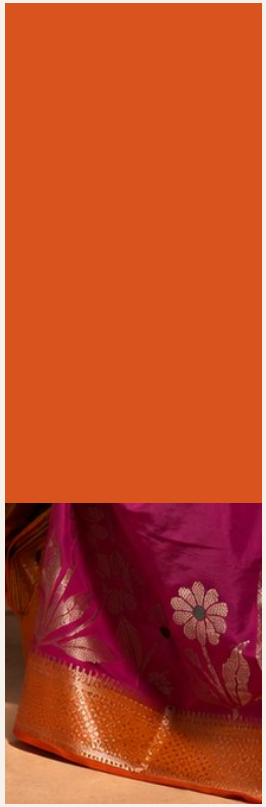
Colour, *woven.*

Colour as editorial, not as a product filter. Each field is paired with the cloth it came from: flat on rest, textile on hover.

Mobile: horizontal snap-scroll at 70vw, each card split into colour field above and macro below, since touch has no hover.



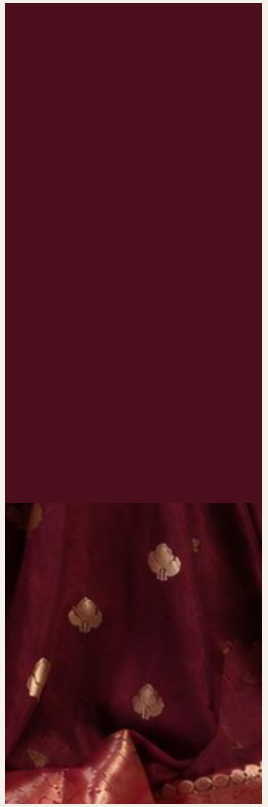
Rani
#A3175F



Marigold
#D9531E



Chartreuse
#B3A21A



Wine
#4A0E1C



Indigo
#1E2150

09

Colour system

Three strictly separated layers:

1. **Foundation:** the interface. Warm neutrals from the studio walls.
2. **Content:** jewel tones from the sarees. Photography and Colour Story only.
3. **Functional:** error and success. Rare.

> The accent **is ink**. A brand whose product is saturated colour has no colour accent in its UI.

FOUNDATION

Ivory
`#F6F1EA`
Page background

Stone
`#EDE5DA`
Secondary surface

Sand
`#E2D7C8`
Hover, skeletons

Linen
`#DDD3C6`
Hairline border

Clay Line
`#B9AB9A`
Strong border · never text

Ink
`#1F1A16`
Text, CTA, accent

Ink Hover
`#3D342D`
Filled CTA hover

Umber
`#4A413A`
Secondary text

Taupe Grey
`#6E645B`
Muted text · AA 5.3:1

Error
`#A3302A`

Success
`#3F5B3A`

ON-SCREEN RATIO, ROUGHLY

~75% Ivory / Stone



~20% photography

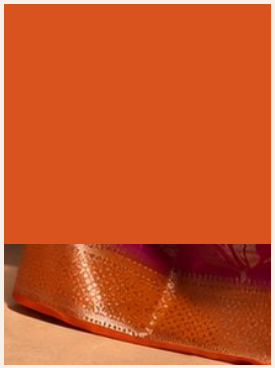
~5% Ink

Content colours

Sampled from the sarees and tuned for flat fields. **Colour Story only**, plus optional load placeholders behind product images. Never buttons, links, borders or icons.



Rani
`#A3175F`
Body · A/B



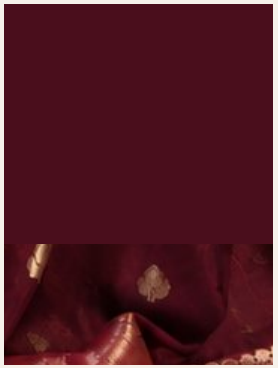
Marigold
`#D9531E`
Border · A/B



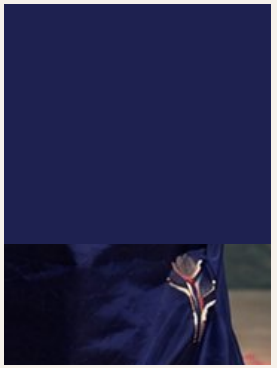
Chartreuse
`#B3A21A`
Body · C



Rose
`#C9607E`
Ombré · C



Wine
`#4A0E1C`
Body · D



Indigo
`#1E2150`
Body · E



Sindoor
`#8E1B2C`
The disc · A/B

Studio neutrals

Sampled from the backdrops. For hero fallback fields and campaign pages, so the page can extend the photograph.

Studio Clay
`#C99E7A`

Plaster
`#E4CBA8`

Shadow Umber
`#6A4A36`

Gold

Gold appears on the site **only as zari inside photographs**. No gold text, buttons, borders, icons, dividers, gradients or foil textures.



✓ Zari, in the photograph



✗ Gold in the UI

The logo on the website

The current SN monogram uses a gold gradient, maroon and ornamental diamonds. That's the "beige + gold + maroon" formula this system avoids. On the website it would pull the whole interface toward bridal luxury.

ON THE WEBSITE

Header: the **STYLISH NAARI wordmark alone**, single-colour SVG. Ink on light, Ivory on images and dark.

Monogram only as favicon, social avatar and packaging stamp, **single-colour**, ideally without the diamonds.

Never the gold/maroon gradient files.

> **Recommendation:** commission a simplified single-weight monogram and wordmark before launch.



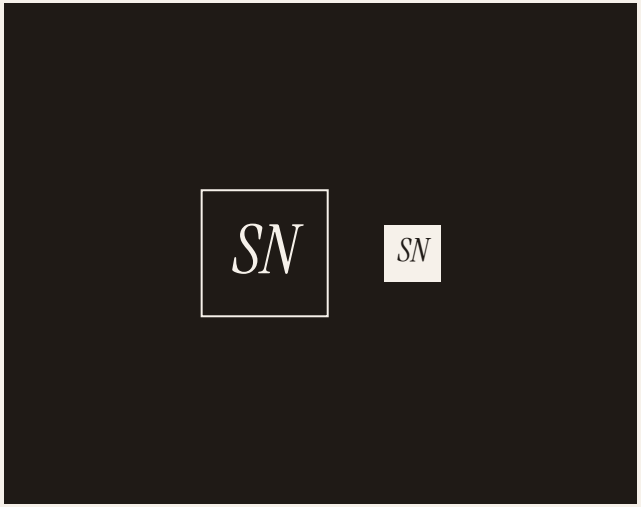
✗ Current file: not for website use



✓ Wordmark, Ink on Ivory



✓ Wordmark, Ivory over imagery



✓ Single-colour monogram: avatar and favicon (placeholder until redrawn)

10

Typography

PRIMARY · DISPLAY & UI

Inter Tight

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk 0123456789 ₹

400 Regular · 500 Medium. A neutral, contemporary grotesk with tight default spacing: editorial at large sizes, crisp in UI.

BODY

Inter

Kairi moves from rose into chartreuse across its length, finished with a gold zari border and scattered floral buti.

400 · 500. Same design DNA, optimised for reading.

EDITORIAL ACCENT · ITALIC ONLY

Instrument Serif

Colour, *woven.*

At most once per section, one or two words, headlines only. Deliberately not a "luxury" serif.

LOADING

Self-host WOFF2 in the theme `assets/` with `font-display: swap`. Subset to Latin + ₹. Preload Inter Tight 400 and Inter 400 only.

WEIGHTS

400 and 500 only. No bold (700) anywhere. No light (300) below 40px.

UPGRADE PATH

License a characterful grotesk (Suisse- or Neue Haas-style) to replace Inter Tight for display. Nothing else changes.

STYLE	SPECIMEN (DESKTOP SIZE ×0.5)	SPEC · MOBILE → DESKTOP
Display	The new Banarasi.	Inter Tight 400 · 48→104 · lh 0.95 · −0.035em
H1	Woven for now.	Inter Tight 400 · 36→64 · lh 1.0 · −0.03em
H2	New arrivals	Inter Tight 400 · 28→40 · lh 1.08 · −0.02em
H3	The Jewel Edit	Inter Tight 500 · 18→22 · lh 1.25 · −0.01em
Body	Handwoven in Varanasi on a traditional loom.	Inter 400 · 15→16 · lh 1.6 · 0
Caption	Dry clean only · 5.5m with blouse piece	Inter 400 · 12→13 · lh 1.45
Navigation	Shop Edits Craft About	Inter Tight 500 · 14 · title case
Product	Kairi Chartreuse and rose ombré, silk ₹ 24,500	Title Inter Tight 500 · 14→15 · descriptor Inter 13→14 muted · price Inter 14→15 tabular
Button / link	Explore the collection →	Inter Tight 500 · 14 · +0.01em · sentence case
Eyebrow	THE FESTIVE EDIT	Inter Tight 500 · 11→12 · +0.14em · UPPERCASE

RULES

Uppercase is for eyebrows and the wordmark only.

Serif italic at most once per section, 1–2 words, H1/H2/Display only.

Measure: 45–65 characters (`max-width: 34em`).

Hierarchy through size and space, not weight.

Prices: ₹ 24,500, Indian grouping, no decimals. Sale prices muted with strikethrough, never red.

Statements end with a full stop (*The new Banarasi.*). Labels don't (*New arrivals*).

11

Layout & grid

The grid is strict so the breaks are noticeable. Content centres beyond 1440px; **full-bleed images keep going** to the viewport edge.



12 columns (tinted), page margins (hatched). Shop by Edit shown: 7-column feature, empty column 8, a stack in 9–12 offset by 128px.

	DESKTOP ≥1280	LAPTOP	TABLET	MOBILE <768
Columns	12	12	8	4
Page margin	48	40	32	16
Gutter	24	20	16	12
Section spacing	160	128	112	80
Header → content	48	40	32	24
Max content width	1440	fluid		

PERMITTED GRID BREAKS

1. **Full-bleed:** Hero, Festive
2. **Edge bleed:** Art of Banarasi image
3. **Vertical offset:** 96 or 128px only
4. **Empty column:** Shop by Edit

Not permitted: rotation, collage overlaps, masked shapes, diagonal sections, random offsets.

12

Components

BUTTONS & LINKS

Explore the collection →

Text + arrow (default)
Hover: underline draws in from left (400ms), arrow nudges 4px.

Size & care guide

Underlined text
Inline, footer, secondary.

Add to bag

Filled, commerce only
Add to bag, checkout, subscribe. 48px tall, 2px radius.

Notify me

Outline
Secondary commerce action.

Never: pills, gradients, gold, shadows, icon-only primaries. One filled button per view. Touch target ≥ 44×44px.

FORMS · NEWSLETTER

Email address

you@example.com

Focused

meera@

Error

meera@gmail

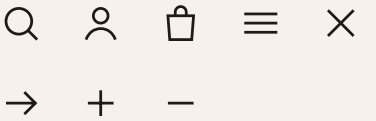
That email doesn't look right. Check it and try again.

Letters from the loom

New sarees, new edits, occasionally a story. Never too often.

Email address Subscribe →

ICONS · 1.5PX LINE, 20PX



Search · account · bag · menu · close · arrow · plus · minus. Nothing decorative.

CORNERS · BORDERS · SHADOWS

Images, sections: **0 radius**

Buttons, inputs: **2px**

Borders: hairline, never around cards

Shadows: **none**. Drawers use a 1px edge + 30% ink overlay.

PRODUCT CARD



Kairi

Chartreuse and rose ombré, silk

₹ XX,XXX

No container. The image is the card. 3:4, text 16px below. Hover: scale 1.03 (1200ms) + detail crossfade.

SOLD OUT STATE



Jamun

Wine with rose zari border, silk

₹ XX,XXX

The only permitted overlay on a product image.

EDITORIAL COLLECTION CARD



The Contrast Edit

Where the border disagrees with the body, beautifully.

Shop the edit →

Text below, never overlaid. No border, background or shadow.

HEADER · OVER HERO



HEADER · ON SCROLL / INNER PAGES



72px desktop, 56px mobile. Nav left · wordmark centre · utilities right.

Utilities as **text** on desktop (Search, Account, Bag), which reads as fashion, not marketplace.

Solid after 80% of the hero; hides on scroll-down, returns on scroll-up.

Shop menu: full-width Ivory panel, three text columns + one campaign image. 150ms open delay, Esc closes.

Announcement bar: optional, one message, 36px, Stone, no marquee.

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Interaction & motion

Slow, soft, confident. Motion should feel like fabric settling, not like an app.

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
`--duration-fast`	200ms	Colour, opacity on links
`--duration-base`	400ms	Underline draw, header state
`--duration-slow`	800ms	Reveal, crossfade, colour swap
`--duration-slower`	1200ms	Image hover zoom
`--ease-out`	`.22, 1, .36, 1`	Default for everything
`--ease-in-out`	`.65, 0, .35, 1`	Drawers, menus



The ease-out curve: fast start, long gentle settle.

PERMITTED

- Image hover zoom: `scale(1.03)`, 1200ms
- Reveal on scroll: fade + 16px rise, 800ms, **once**, 80ms stagger
- Hero image fades in over 1200ms after load; headline 200ms later
- Colour Story fields crossfade to textile on hover
- Header background transition on scroll
- Cart and menu drawers slide, 400ms

NOT PERMITTED

Parallax · auto-advancing carousels · marquees · letter-split text animations · cursor followers · motif animations · confetti · sparkles · bounce or elastic easing · scroll-jacking

FEEDBACK WITHIN 400MS

Add to bag updates the count immediately (optimistic), the button reads **Added** for 2s, and the cart drawer opens. Every async action shows a pending state.

REDUCED MOTION

Respect `prefers-reduced-motion`: disable reveal, zoom and hero fade; keep instant state changes.

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Responsive

Mobile is designed, not stacked. Every section has its own mobile composition.

Hero: native 2:3, uncropped

New arrivals: 1.25 cards, snap-scroll, no offset

Edits: large card full-bleed; small pair indented left, bleeding right

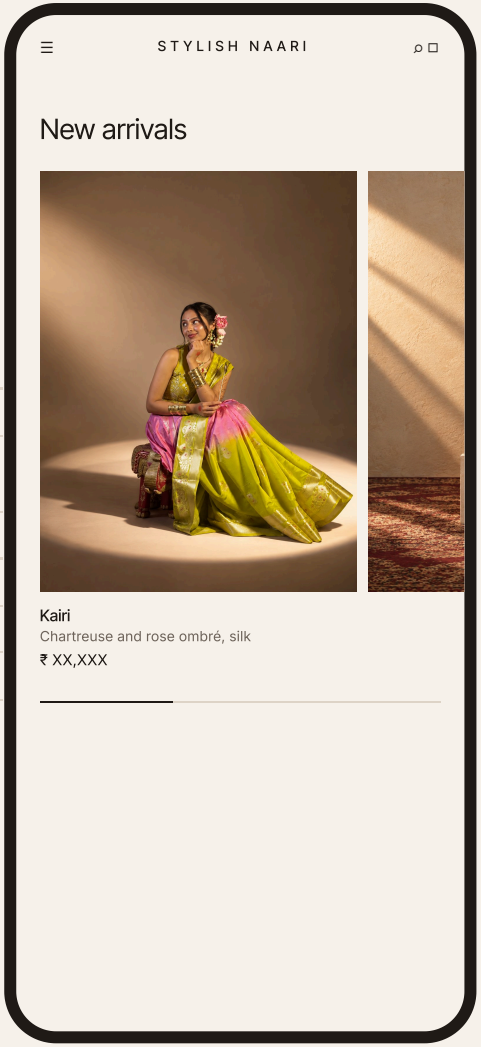
Colour story: snap-scroll, split cards

Craft: image full-bleed, text below

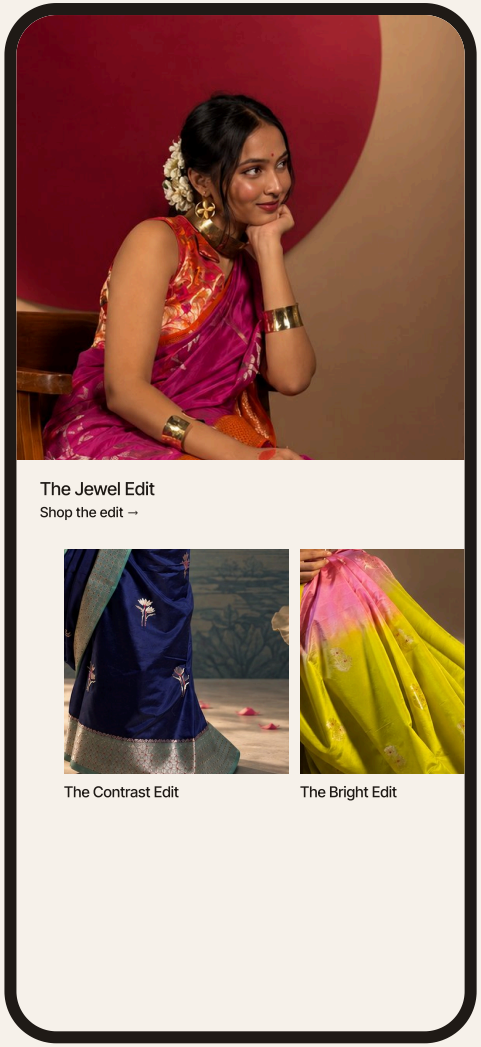
Festive: full-bleed, text on ink scrim

Footer: newsletter first, link groups as accordions

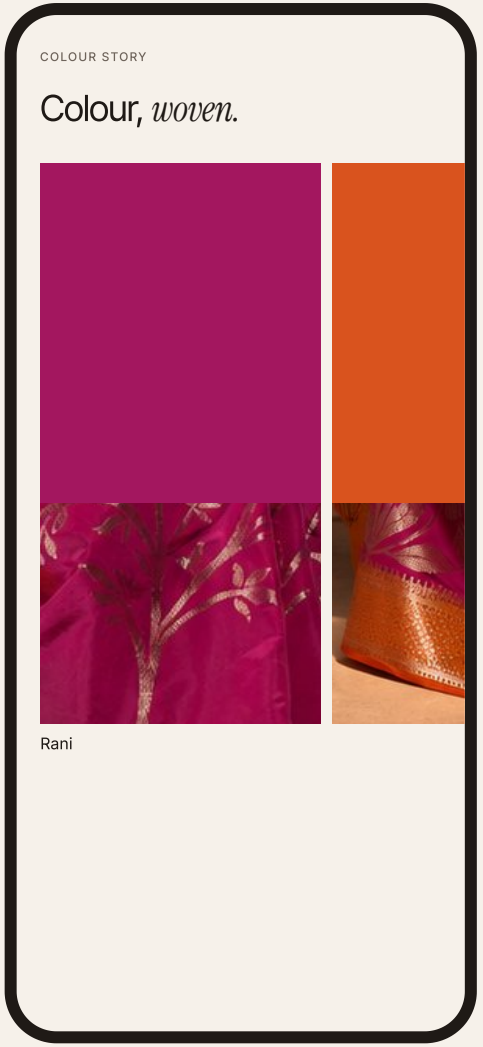
Type uses `clamp()` between mobile and desktop sizes. Section spacing 160 → 128 → 112 → 80px.



New arrivals: the next card peeks



Edits: asymmetry is kept



Colour story: split cards

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Brand voice

Confident · short · cultured · contemporary · warm · understated. She talks like a friend who works in fashion: not a salesperson, not a historian.

PRINCIPLES

1. **Say less.** Cut the second sentence. Then check the first.
2. **Be specific.** "Marigold border" beats "vibrant hues".
3. **Present tense, present day.** The craft is old; the brand isn't.
4. **Warm, not gushing.** One adjective at a time.
5. **Heritage is a fact, not a pitch.** State it plainly, move on.
6. **Hindi words only where English has none better:** saree, pallu, zari, buti, jaal.

TONE REFERENCES, NOT TAGLINES

Banarasi, reimagined. · Woven in colour. · Made for now. · Silk, zari, and a little more colour.

BANNED

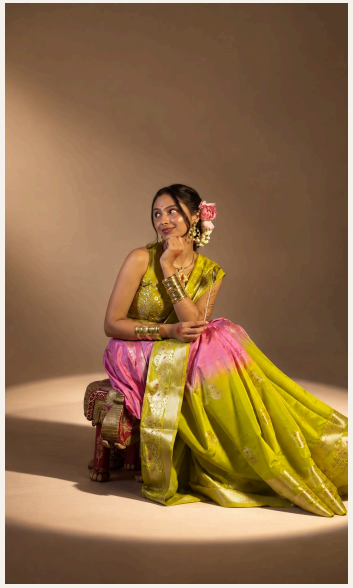
~~Timeless elegance~~ · ~~Where tradition meets modernity~~ · ~~Embrace your heritage~~ · ~~Celebrating the rich heritage of India~~ · ~~Luxury sarees for the modern woman~~ · ~~Exquisite~~ · ~~Regal~~ · ~~Fit for a queen~~ · ~~Drape yourself in...~~ · ~~Grace and poise~~ · ~~Ethnic wear~~ · ~~Hurry, limited stock!~~

MICROCOPY

WRITE	NOT
Add to bag	~~ADD TO CART NOW~~
Your bag is empty. Start with the new arrivals →	~~Oops! Nothing here yet 😭~~
Sold out · Notify me	~~OUT OF STOCK~~
Thank you — you're on the list.	~~Congratulations! You have successfully subscribed!~~
That email doesn't look right. Check it and try again.	~~Invalid input.~~
This page has unravelled. Back to the collection →	~~404 ERROR PAGE NOT FOUND~~

Product naming

One word, occasionally two, from Indian everyday life (fruit, flowers, seasons, places), chosen for colour and mood. Proposed names; confirm fibre and weave per SKU.



Kairi

raw mango

Chartreuse and rose ombré, silk



Jamun

Indian blackberry

Wine with rose zari border, silk



Neel

indigo

Indigo with aqua-silver border, silk



Bagh

garden

Magenta jaal with marigold border, silk

DESCRIPTION TEMPLATE

[Name] is [the body colour, the motif, the border].
[One line on how it wears or where it goes.]

Silk · [weave] · Handwoven in Varanasi · 5.5m with unstitched blouse piece · Dry clean

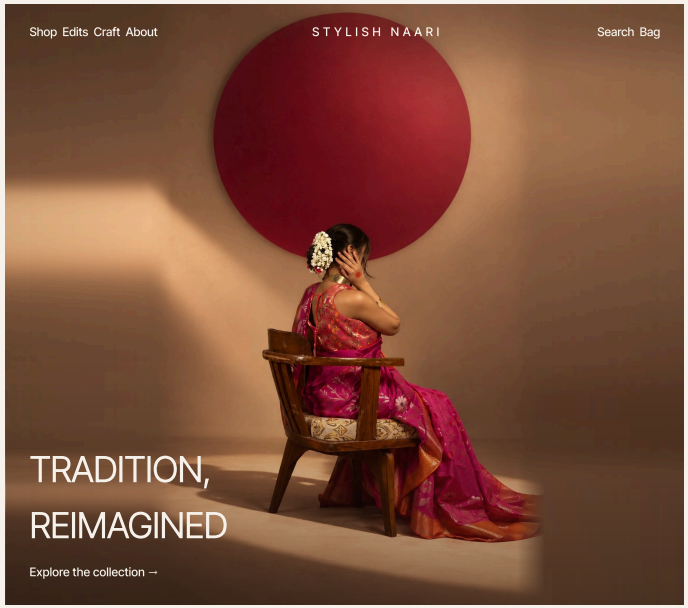
EXAMPLE

Kairi moves from rose into chartreuse across its length, finished with a gold zari border and scattered floral buti. Made for a daytime celebration, or anything that needs more colour.

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Do / Don't

Put a screenshot next to three generic "ethnic wear" stores and one contemporary Indian fashion label. It should obviously belong with the label.



✓ Image leads, one line, one quiet CTA, ivory grotesk.



✗ Gold gradients, ornate frame, motifs, cliché copy, discount pill.



Jamun
Wine with rose zari border, silk
₹ XX,XXX

✓ Clean card



✗ Crowded card

DO

Contemporary Indian · restrained UI · strong photography · rich textile colour · generous whitespace · editorial layouts · modern typography · tactile imagery · subtle interactions · strong composition · premium restraint

DON'T

Traditional wedding website · "Indian luxury" clichés · excessive gold · ornate borders · paisley, mandala, lotus or peacock decoration · palace imagery · stock photography · excessive beige or maroon · generic luxury serif · crowded cards · rounded, bubbly cards · discount-heavy UI · floral UI · "timeless elegance" copy

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Shopify implementation

Build on **Dawn** (or an equally lean Online Store 2.0 theme), stripped back to this system. Tokens in one `assets/base-tokens.css`. No page-builder apps. The homepage looks custom because of **composition and content**, not one-off code.

SECTION FILE	USE	KEY SETTINGS
`announcement-bar`	Optional	Text, link, toggle
`header`	Global	Menu, wordmark SVG, transparent-over-hero
`hero-campaign`	01	Desktop + mobile image, headline, line, CTA, text position, scrim 0–40%
`product-row-editorial`	02	Collection, limit, offset-centre toggle, image source
`edits-asymmetric`	03	Edit blocks: collection, image, title, descriptor
`colour-story`	04	Heading (with), colour blocks: name, hex, macro
`image-with-text-editorial`	05	Image side, edge-bleed, Ivory/Stone, copy, CTA
`campaign-feature`	06	Main + detail image, Ink/Ivory theme, copy
`footer`	Global	3 menus, social, newsletter copy

METAFIELDS

METAFIELD	PURPOSE
`product.custom.descriptor`	Line under title
`product.custom.campaign_image`	Model image for editorial cards
`product.custom.detail_image`	Hover crossfade
`product.custom.colour_family`	→ colour metaobjects
`product.custom.weave / care`	PDP spec block
`collection.custom.edit_descriptor`	Edit one-liner
`collection.custom.edit_image`	Edit card image
`metaobject colour`	Name, hex, macro image

Card image: `campaign_image` if present, otherwise `featured_image`.

GUARDRAILS

Performance: hero LCP ≤ 2.5s on 4G; preload hero + 2 fonts; no carousel or animation libraries.

Images: masters ≥ 3000px; `image_url` srcset 375–2800.

Accessibility: WCAG 2.2 AA, visible focus, keyboard menus, descriptive alt text.

Apps: none may inject homepage UI without review. Chat: a small ink icon, no green bubble.

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Design tokens

Full file in `brand-guidelines.md` §18 → `assets/base-tokens.css`

```
/* Colour: foundation */
--color-bg:              #F6F1EA;
--color-surface:         #EDE5DA;
--color-surface-2:       #E2D7C8;
--color-text:            #1F1A16;
--color-text-secondary: #4A413A;
--color-text-muted:      #6E645B;
--color-border:          #DDD3C6;
--color-border-strong:   #B9AB9A;
--color-ivory:           #F6F1EA;
--color-ink:             #1F1A16;

/* Interactive */
--color-accent:          #1F1A16;
--color-accent-hover:    #3D342D;
--color-accent-contrast:#F6F1EA;

/* Functional */
--color-error:           #A3302A;
--color-success:         #3F5B3A;
```

```
/* Content (Colour Story only) */
--story-rani:       #A3175F;
--story-marigold:   #D9531E;
--story-chartreuse: #B3A21A;
--story-rose:       #C9607E;
--story-wine:       #4A0E1C;
--story-indigo:     #1E2150;
--story-sindoor:    #8E1B2C;

/* Studio (campaign only) */
--color-studio-clay:    #C99E7A;
--color-studio-plaster: #E4CBA8;
--color-studio-umber:   #6A4A36;

/* Families */
--font-display: "Inter Tight";
--font-body:    "Inter";
--font-accent:  "Instrument Serif";
```

```
/* Type (mobile → desktop) */
--font-size-display: 48 → 104px;
--font-size-h1:      36 → 64px;
--font-size-h2:      28 → 40px;
--font-size-h3:      18 → 22px;
--font-size-body-lg: 17 → 19px;
--font-size-body:    15 → 16px;
--font-size-caption: 12 → 13px;
--font-size-eyebrow: 11 → 12px;

/* Spacing, 4px base */
--spacing-1…12: 4 8 12 16 24 32
                40 48 64 96 128 160
--section-spacing: 80 → 160px;
```

```
/* Radius */
--radius-none: 0;
--radius-sm:   2px;
--radius-full: 999px;

/* Layout */
--container-width: 1440px;
--grid-columns: 12 / 8 / 4;
--page-margin:  48 / 40 / 32 / 16;
--grid-gutter:  24 / 20 / 16 / 12;

/* Motion */
--duration-fast:   200ms;
--duration-base:   400ms;
--duration-slow:   800ms;
--duration-slower: 1200ms;
--ease-out: cubic-bezier(
  .22, 1, .36, 1);
--hover-zoom: 1.03;
```

OPEN DECISIONS BEFORE BUILD

1 Landscape hero extension

Image A at 16:9 and 21:9. Required for desktop.

2 Simplified single-colour logo

The gold/maroon monogram conflicts with this system.

3 Product names and descriptors

Confirm the proposed names and each saree's weave and fibre.

4 Craft photography

To replace the interim crop in The Art of Banarasi.

5 A detail image per product

For card hover and product pages.

